

Delta Advanced Trucking, Inc.

Email & Communications Policy

Policy Number: DAT-IT-010	Version: 2.0	Effective Date: December 12, 2025	Classification: Internal
Owner: IT Security Department	Approved By: Chief Executive Officer	Review Cycle: Annual	Next Review: December 2026

1. Purpose

This policy establishes professional standards and security requirements governing the use of email and all other forms of electronic communications at Delta Advanced Trucking, Inc. (hereinafter "the Company" or "DAT"). Its intent is to ensure that electronic communications remain effective, secure, legally compliant, and consistent with the Company's professional image and operational obligations in the transportation and logistics industry.

The trucking and logistics sector faces elevated and specific cybersecurity risks — including Business Email Compromise (BEC), freight payment fraud, and cargo information theft — that make disciplined email governance a critical operational and financial control. This policy directly addresses those risks in addition to standard corporate communication requirements.

2. Scope

This policy applies to **all individuals** who access or use Delta Advanced Trucking email systems, electronic messaging platforms, collaboration tools, or any other

Company-provided or Company-related electronic communication channels, including but not limited to:

- Full-time and part-time employees (including drivers, dispatchers, administrative, and corporate staff)
- Contractors, temporary workers, and staffing agency personnel
- Vendors, partners, and third parties granted access to DAT communication systems

Covered communication channels include, but are not limited to: Company email (Microsoft 365 or equivalent), Microsoft Teams and other approved instant messaging platforms, SMS and dispatch messaging systems, collaboration and file-sharing tools, and any electronic channel used for Company business purposes.

3. Definitions

Term	Definition
Business Email	An email account issued by Delta Advanced Trucking, Inc. under a Company-owned domain (e.g., @deltaadvancedtrucking.com), used for official Company communications.
Personal Email	Any email account not issued or controlled by the Company (e.g., Gmail, Yahoo, Outlook personal, iCloud), regardless of whether it is accessed on a Company device.
Phishing	A fraudulent attempt to obtain sensitive information or credentials by disguising malicious communication as a legitimate source, typically delivered via email.
Spear Phishing	A targeted phishing attack directed at a specific individual or organization, often leveraging personalized information to increase credibility and success rate.
Business Email Compromise (BEC)	A sophisticated scam in which cybercriminals impersonate executives, vendors, or partners via email to fraudulently redirect payments, change

Term	Definition
	banking information, or authorize wire transfers. BEC is a primary threat to the trucking and logistics industry.
Email Spoofing	The forgery of an email sender address so that a message appears to originate from a trusted source when it does not.
Spam	Unsolicited bulk or commercial email sent without the recipient's consent, often for marketing, fraudulent, or malicious purposes.
DLP (Data Loss Prevention)	Technology and policy controls designed to detect and prevent the unauthorized transmission of sensitive or confidential Company data outside the organization.
Email Encryption	A method of encoding email message content so that only the intended authorized recipient can read it, protecting data in transit from interception.
Digital Signature	A cryptographic mechanism attached to an email that verifies the identity of the sender and confirms that the message has not been altered in transit.
Collaboration Platform	Any Company-approved software tool used for real-time messaging, file sharing, video conferencing, or team-based work (e.g., Microsoft Teams). Personal or unapproved platforms are not covered under this definition for Company use.

4. Acceptable Email Use

Company-issued email accounts are provided primarily for business purposes. The following standards govern acceptable use of DAT email and communications systems.

4.1 Business Purpose & Limited Personal Use

Company email is designated for legitimate business communications. Incidental personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with job performance,

consume excessive system resources, violate any provision of this policy, or create legal liability for the Company. Personal use is a privilege, not a right, and may be revoked at any time.

4.2 Professional Tone in External Communications

All external email communications sent on behalf of Delta Advanced Trucking, Inc. must reflect a professional tone, accurate grammar, and appropriate business language. Employees represent the Company's brand and reputation in every message sent to customers, carriers, brokers, vendors, and partners.

4.3 Email Signature Standard

All employees sending external business email must use the Company-approved email signature template. The standard signature must include the following elements:

- Full legal name and preferred name (if applicable)
- Job title and department
- Delta Advanced Trucking, Inc.
- Direct phone number and/or company main line
- Company website address
- Any required regulatory or legal disclaimer (provided by Legal/IT)

The IT Department provides the approved signature template and installation instructions. Unauthorized modification of the required disclaimer text is prohibited.

4.4 Prohibited Uses of Company Email

Company email accounts must not be used to:

- Harass, threaten, bully, or discriminate against any individual based on any protected characteristic
- Distribute obscene, offensive, sexually explicit, or otherwise inappropriate content
- Conduct personal business, freelance work, or operate outside businesses
- Send or forward chain letters, pyramid schemes, or mass solicitations

- Engage in political campaigning, fundraising, or advocacy not authorized by Company leadership
 - Circumvent any security control, filter, or monitoring system
 - Violate any applicable federal, state, or local law or regulation
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5. Prohibited Communications

The following specific communication behaviors are strictly prohibited and may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, as well as potential legal consequences:

- **Transmitting Confidential or Restricted data via unencrypted email.**
Any email containing Confidential or Restricted information sent externally must use approved email encryption. Alternatively, data must be transmitted via the Company-approved secure file transfer platform.
- **Forwarding Company email to personal email accounts.** Employees must not automatically or manually forward Company business emails to personal or external accounts. This includes the use of email-forwarding rules that redirect corporate mail to personal inboxes.
- **Using personal email for Company business involving sensitive data.**
Personal accounts lack the security controls, logging, and retention capabilities required by Company policy and applicable law.
- **Sending mass unsolicited email (spam) from Company systems.** Bulk commercial emails must be coordinated through approved marketing platforms with Legal and Marketing approval.
- **Communicating with media, investors, or analysts without authorization.** All media inquiries and investor communications must be directed to and approved by the Company's Public Relations or Legal Department before any response is provided.

- **Making unauthorized commitments on behalf of the Company.**

Employees must not use email to make binding financial commitments, contractual agreements, or representations of Company policy outside the scope of their authorized role.

6. Email Security Requirements

6.1 Email Authentication

The Company's email domain is protected by industry-standard email authentication protocols: **SPF (Sender Policy Framework)**, **DKIM (DomainKeys Identified Mail)**, and **DMARC (Domain-based Message Authentication, Reporting, and Conformance)**. These controls prevent unauthorized parties from sending email that appears to originate from a DAT domain, significantly reducing spoofing and impersonation risk.

The IT Department is responsible for maintaining all email-related DNS records. Employees must not configure any unauthorized email-sending service, third-party application, or device to send email on behalf of any Company email domain without prior written IT approval.

6.2 Anti-Phishing Controls

The Company's email gateway is equipped with advanced anti-phishing and anti-malware filtering technology. All inbound email is scanned prior to delivery. In addition:

- A **"Report Phishing" button** is enabled in all Company email clients; employees are required to use this function to report any suspected phishing attempt.
- The IT Security team reviews all reported phishing submissions and communicates relevant threat intelligence to affected users and management.

- External sender banners or warning labels are applied to email originating outside the Company network to assist employees in identifying potentially suspicious messages.

6.3 Encrypted Email

Encrypted email is required for all externally transmitted messages containing Confidential or Restricted data as defined in the DAT Data Classification Policy (DAT-IT-005). The approved encryption method is **Microsoft Purview Message Encryption (or equivalent IT-approved solution)**. Employees who require encrypted email capability must submit a request to the IT Help Desk for provisioning and training.

When Is Encryption Required?

Use encrypted email any time your message contains: customer financial data, driver personal information (SSN, license, medical), rate confirmations containing proprietary pricing, cargo manifest details, or any information classified Confidential or Restricted. When in doubt, encrypt — or use the secure file transfer portal.

6.4 Attachment Security

The following attachment security controls are enforced at the email gateway level:

- **Executable attachments are blocked:** File types including .exe, .bat, .ps1, .vbs, .cmd, .msi, and similar executable formats are automatically quarantined and will not be delivered.
- **Macro-enabled Office documents are scanned** and may be blocked or sandboxed pending security analysis if detected as suspicious.
- **Large file transfers must use the Company-approved secure file sharing platform** (e.g., SharePoint, OneDrive for Business, or IT-approved equivalent) rather than email attachments, to ensure proper access control, versioning, and auditability.

6.5 Email Retention

Email retention is governed by the Company's Records Retention Schedule. Standard retention periods are as follows:

Email Category	Retention Period	Notes
Standard Business Email	3 Years	Default retention; auto-archived per IT policy
Financial & Contract-Related	7 Years	Per regulatory and tax requirements
HR & Employment Matters	7 Years	Coordinated with HR Department
Legal Hold Email	Indefinite (until released)	Override issued by Legal Department in writing

Legal hold overrides the standard retention schedule. When notified by the Legal Department of a legal hold, employees must immediately suspend deletion of any covered email and preserve all relevant communications as instructed.

7. Phishing & Social Engineering Awareness

Human awareness is the most critical defense against phishing and social engineering attacks. All employees are required to follow these practices:

- **Never click links or open attachments from unexpected or unverified sources** without first independently confirming the sender's identity through a known, trusted contact method (e.g., a phone call to a number on file — not the one provided in the suspicious email).
- **Verify all wire transfer and payment requests by phone** using a known, pre-established number before acting. Do not reply to the email or use contact information contained within the request. BEC attacks specifically target trucking and logistics companies for freight payment fraud — treat any payment-related email with heightened scrutiny.

- **Use the "Report Phishing" button** to report suspicious email. Do not forward suspicious emails to coworkers, as forwarding can activate malicious links or spread the threat.
- **Be alert to urgency and pressure tactics.** Legitimate internal requests for payments, password resets, or sensitive data will not require you to bypass normal approval processes under time pressure.



Quarterly Phishing Simulations

IT Security conducts quarterly phishing simulation exercises using industry-standard testing platforms. Employees who interact with simulated phishing messages will receive targeted training and coaching — this is a learning opportunity, not a punitive measure. Persistent failure to recognize simulated phishing may result in escalated mandatory training requirements.

8. Instant Messaging & Collaboration Tools

Delta Advanced Trucking authorizes the use of the following instant messaging and collaboration platform(s) for Company business:

- **Microsoft Teams** (or Company-approved equivalent, as designated by IT)

The following restrictions apply to all collaboration platform usage:

- **Personal messaging applications** — including WhatsApp, Signal, iMessage, Facebook Messenger, and similar consumer-grade platforms — are not approved for any Company business communications that involve Confidential, Restricted, or customer-sensitive data.
- All data stored in or transmitted through approved collaboration platforms is subject to the same retention, security, and compliance standards as Company email.

- Collaboration platform accounts must use Company credentials. Employees must not share access credentials or add unauthorized external users to Company channels or workspaces.
 - IT Security may review collaboration platform logs and content in accordance with Company monitoring policy DAT-IT-001.
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9. SMS & Text Communications

Short Message Service (SMS) and text-based communications are subject to the following standards:

- **Company-issued SMS for operational dispatch communications is approved** for routine driver communication, load updates, and operational coordination conducted through the Company's dispatch platform.
 - **Driver communications should be conducted through the Company's approved dispatch platform** wherever possible to ensure logging, compliance, and FMCSA regulatory recordkeeping.
 - **Personal SMS is discouraged for Company business** involving sensitive data. If personal SMS is used for operational convenience, it must not contain: customer financial information, load pricing details, personally identifiable information of drivers or employees, or any data classified Confidential or Restricted.
 - SMS is **not a secure channel** for Confidential data and must not substitute for approved secure communication methods for any sensitive transaction.
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10. Social Media & External Posting

Employees who use social media platforms in any capacity must adhere to the following standards to protect both the Company's security posture and its professional reputation:

- **Do not represent personal views as Company positions.** When posting about industry topics or Company-related matters, clearly identify that the views expressed are your own.
 - **Do not post operational details, routes, cargo information, shipment schedules, or customer details on any social media platform.** This information is operationally sensitive and may be exploited by cargo thieves, competitors, or bad actors targeting the supply chain.
 - **Refer all media inquiries to the Company spokesperson** or Public Relations Department. Do not grant interviews, make statements, or respond to media questions on behalf of Delta Advanced Trucking without explicit written authorization.
 - Official Delta Advanced Trucking social media accounts are managed exclusively by the Marketing Department, with IT Security review of account access controls and security settings. Employees must not create unofficial Company accounts or pages.
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11. Legal Considerations

Employees must understand the following legal realities governing Company electronic communications:

- **Company email is Company property.** All email sent or received through Company systems, on Company devices, or through Company network infrastructure is the property of Delta Advanced Trucking, Inc. and is subject to monitoring and review per DAT-IT-001.
- **Email is discoverable in litigation.** Emails — including deleted emails — may be subject to e-discovery in legal proceedings. Employees should write all business email as if it may one day be read in a courtroom or by a regulatory body.
- **Emails may constitute binding contracts.** Written commitments, acceptances, and agreements made via email may be legally binding on the

Company. Only authorized personnel may make contractual commitments via email.

- **Legal hold compliance is mandatory.** Upon notification from the Legal Department that a legal hold is in effect, employees must immediately preserve all relevant electronic communications and suspend any automatic deletion settings for covered accounts.
- **Attorney-client privilege.** Communications with the Company's Legal counsel may be protected by attorney-client privilege. Such emails should be marked "ATTORNEY-CLIENT PRIVILEGED AND CONFIDENTIAL" in the subject line and must not be forwarded or shared without Legal approval.

12. Business Email Compromise (BEC) Prevention

Business Email Compromise represents one of the most financially damaging cyber threats facing the transportation and logistics industry. The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center (IC3) has consistently identified freight and logistics companies as high-priority BEC targets due to the volume and velocity of financial transactions, the complexity of the vendor ecosystem, and the prevalence of wire-transfer payment practices.

INDUSTRY ALERT: BEC Targets Trucking & Logistics

Freight payment fraud, double-brokering scams, and invoice manipulation schemes are actively and specifically targeting trucking companies. Criminals impersonate brokers, shippers, or DAT executives to redirect payments, change banking details, or authorize fraudulent wire transfers. A single successful BEC attack can result in losses of tens of thousands to hundreds of thousands of dollars.

Common BEC attack patterns in trucking:

- Fake load broker emails directing payment to fraudulent accounts

- Vendor impersonation requesting banking detail changes via email
- Executive impersonation ("CEO fraud") requesting urgent wire transfers
- Fuel card or factoring account fraud via compromised credentials
- Carrier impersonation to intercept freight payments

If you receive any payment-related instruction via email, stop — verify by phone before acting.

The following mandatory BEC prevention controls are in effect at Delta Advanced Trucking, Inc.:

- **CFO / Controller dual approval** is required for any wire transfer request, regardless of whether it is received via email, that was not pre-scheduled through the normal accounts payable process. No single employee is authorized to approve a wire transfer based solely on email instruction.
 - **Vendor banking changes must be verified by phone** using a number independently sourced from Company records — not from the email containing the change request. Finance must document the verification call before processing any banking updates.
 - **Finance and accounts payable team members receive specific BEC awareness training** at onboarding and annually, with scenario-based exercises targeting freight payment fraud patterns.
 - **Anomalous payment requests must be escalated immediately** to the employee's manager and the IT Security team. Do not attempt to handle a suspected BEC incident alone.
 - **New vendor payment instructions** received via email must be cross-referenced against the original contract or onboarding documentation before any payment is initiated.
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13. Data Loss Prevention (DLP)

Delta Advanced Trucking deploys Data Loss Prevention technology to monitor and, where necessary, block the unauthorized outbound transmission of sensitive Company data via email and other communication channels.

- **DLP rules are configured** to detect outbound email patterns consistent with sensitive data categories including: personally identifiable information (PII), financial data, driver records, customer contracts, and proprietary rate information.
- **Employees will be notified** when a DLP policy blocks or quarantines an outbound email. The notification will include guidance on the appropriate alternative method for transmitting the data.
- **If a DLP block is believed to be in error**, the employee must contact the IT Help Desk to review the message and, if appropriate, request a DLP exception. DLP exceptions require managerial approval and IT Security review.
- **DLP logs are reviewed periodically** by IT Security for patterns indicating policy violations, potential insider threats, or misconfigured exceptions.

DLP Block? Re-Route — Do Not Circumvent

Attempting to bypass a DLP control — by splitting files, obfuscating data, using personal email, or other methods — is a serious policy violation and may constitute grounds for immediate disciplinary action, including termination. If you believe a DLP restriction is incorrectly applied, contact IT Security through the proper exception process.

14. Enforcement

Compliance with this policy is mandatory for all covered individuals. Violations of this policy will be investigated and may result in disciplinary action commensurate with the severity, intent, and impact of the violation, up to and including:

- Verbal or written warning
- Mandatory remedial cybersecurity training
- Suspension of email or system access privileges
- Termination of employment or contractor engagement
- Civil or criminal referral where applicable law has been violated

Contractors and vendors found in violation of this policy may have their Company system access revoked immediately and may be subject to remedies specified in their applicable service agreement. The Company reserves the right to monitor, audit, and inspect all communications conducted through Company-owned or Company-managed systems, as further described in DAT-IT-001 (Acceptable Use Policy).

15. Policy Review

This policy shall be reviewed on an **annual basis** by the IT Security Department and the Legal Department, or more frequently as required by changes in applicable law, technology, regulatory requirements, or emerging threat intelligence. Review findings and any recommended amendments shall be submitted to the Chief Executive Officer or designated executive sponsor for approval prior to issuance of a revised version.

Version	Date	Description of Change	Approved By
1.0	January 15, 2023	Initial policy issuance	CEO
2.0	December 12, 2025	Full policy modernization; added BEC	CEO

Version	Date	Description of Change	Approved By
		prevention controls, DLP, collaboration tool standards, trucking-specific phishing guidance, and expanded legal section	

Approved and Authorized:

L. Thomas Marchland

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Chief Executive Officer, Delta Advanced Trucking, Inc.

Date: December 12, 2025

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